

# Verified Database Architecture and Taxonomy of Indian Competitive Examinations

The structural integrity of any career-guidance platform operating within the Indian educational ecosystem relies on the absolute precision of its temporal, regulatory, and demographic data. An erroneous entry regarding age limits, attempt caps, or examination status does not merely represent a data anomaly; it constitutes a catastrophic failure for the end-user, often resulting in a squandered academic year or permanent disqualification from a career trajectory. The systemic commercialization of the Indian education sector has generated a proliferation of pseudo-examinations, outdated information, and coaching-industry marketing constructs that masquerade as official academic milestones. This document provides an exhaustive, verified architectural schema for Indian entrance and competitive examinations, systematically dismantling prevalent fallacies, reconstructing examination timelines, mapping alternative vocational pathways, and delivering a rigidly structured data taxonomy designed for immediate database integration.

## Resolution of Institutional Fallacies and Phantom Examinations

The foundational step in database sanitization requires the identification and removal of widely believed but factually incorrect examination claims. The educational landscape is rife with historical programs that have been decommissioned, as well as fabricated constructs designed to exploit parental anxiety.

The National Talent Search Examination (NTSE) serves as the most prominent example of an obsolete entry requiring immediate rectification. The NTSE is definitively stalled and is no longer conducted by the National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT). The scheme, fully funded by the Ministry of Education, received official administrative approval only until March 31, 2021<sup>1</sup>. Following a prolonged period of uncertainty, the NCERT released official notifications in late 2022 confirming that further implementation of the scheme in its present form had not been approved and was stalled until further orders<sup>2</sup>. While there are reports that the government intends to revamp the scheme to increase visibility among rural candidates, no active examination currently exists<sup>4</sup>. Furthermore, historical data indicates that Class 9 students were never eligible for the NTSE in its standard domestic format, which was strictly restricted to Class 10 students<sup>5</sup>. The singular exception applied to Indian students studying abroad, who were permitted to submit Class 9 transcripts to bypass the state-level Stage 1 and register directly for the national-level Stage 2 examination<sup>7</sup>.

Similarly, the PM Young Achievers Scholarship Award Scheme for Vibrant India (PM YASASVI), designed for Other Backward Classes (OBC), Economically Backward Classes (EBC), and De-Notified Tribes (DNT), has undergone a fundamental structural shift. The associated

entrance examination, known as the YASASVI Entrance Test (YET) previously conducted by the National Testing Agency (NTA), has been permanently discontinued<sup>8</sup>. The scholarship itself remains active, offering financial assistance to Class 9 and Class 11 students, but the selection mechanism has pivoted to a purely merit-based system relying on the candidate's previous year school examination marks<sup>8</sup>. Retaining the YET as an active entrance exam in any database will severely mislead applicants.

The military preparatory ecosystem also suffers from widespread misinformation regarding entry points. The Rashtriya Indian Military College (RIMC) maintains highly restrictive and uncompromising entry parameters. Admissions are granted exclusively into Class VIII<sup>9</sup>. The age window operates on a strict continuum: candidates must be at least eleven and a half years old and not more than thirteen years of age at the time of admission<sup>9</sup>. The candidate must be actively studying in Class VII or have passed Class VII from a recognized school at the time of joining<sup>9</sup>. Claims of Class 6 or Class 9 entry into RIMC are entirely false. Conversely, the All India Sainik Schools Entrance Exam (AISSEE) strictly bifurcates its admissions into Class VI and Class IX, establishing a parallel but distinct pipeline that does not intersect with the RIMC entry model.

Within the private coaching industry, terms such as "JEE Foundation" and "NEET Foundation" have gained immense traction. These are completely fabricated examination categories and possess no official standing. They are not recognized by the National Testing Agency (NTA), the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE), or any statutory educational body<sup>10</sup>. These terminologies are purely marketing constructs and product names created by the private coaching industry to enroll students from Classes 6 through 10 into long-term, high-cost coaching funnels<sup>10</sup>. Any database entry listing these as official entrance examinations validates predatory marketing and corrupts the integrity of the platform.

The vocational and technical education sectors require similar disambiguation. The Industrial Training Institute (ITI) Apprenticeship is frequently misunderstood as an entrance examination. In reality, it is a post-certification placement and training scheme governed by the Apprentices Act of 1961. It represents a contractual period of on-the-job training within the industry, occasionally culminating in the All India Trade Test (AITT) for apprentices to receive a National Apprenticeship Certificate (NAC), but it is not a preliminary entrance test. Furthermore, State-level Common Entrance Tests for Polytechnics, such as JEECUP in Uttar Pradesh or TS POLYCET in Telangana, are universally positioned after Class 10<sup>12</sup>. They serve as the primary gateway to three-year engineering and non-engineering diploma programs, requiring candidates to have passed their secondary school examinations with mathematics and science as core subjects<sup>12</sup>.

## **Examination Pathways by Educational Stage**

To construct a robust and highly accurate database, the user journey must be mapped according to the strict chronological progression of the Indian academic system. This requires defining the legitimate examinations available at each distinct stage while explicitly noting where genuine testing ecosystems do not exist.

The landscape for Class 9 students is remarkably sparse following the suspension of the NTSE.

The only legitimate, globally recognized academic assessments available at this stage are the Homi Bhabha Centre for Science Education (HBCSE) Olympiads. The anchor examination for this cohort is the National Standard Examination in Junior Science (NSEJS), which is conducted by the Indian Association of Physics Teachers (IAPT) in collaboration with HBCSE<sup>13</sup>. This examination requires candidates to meet strict age brackets and hold Indian citizenship, serving as the first stage in a rigorous pipeline leading to the International Junior Science Olympiad<sup>13</sup>. Beyond this, legitimate talent searches for Class 9 are virtually nonexistent, and the platform must explicitly warn users against investing time in unrecognized private talent tests. Progression into Class 10 marks the first major branching point in the Indian educational matrix. At this juncture, students may opt for the traditional higher secondary route or pivot toward technical and vocational training. For those pursuing technical diplomas, the State Polytechnic Common Entrance Tests become the primary objective<sup>12</sup>. For students aiming to remain in the standard academic track, the HBCSE Olympiads, including the Indian Olympiad Qualifier in Mathematics (IOQM) and the NSEJS, provide the highest level of competitive exposure<sup>13</sup>. Class 11 serves primarily as a preparatory and transitional year. Historically, the Kishore Vaigyanik Protsahan Yojana (KVPY) provided a high-stakes testing environment for this cohort, but the Department of Science and Technology discontinued the fellowship test in 2022, subsuming it into the INSPIRE fellowship scheme<sup>17</sup>. Consequently, Class 11 students focus predominantly on senior HBCSE science olympiads, such as the National Standard Examination in Physics (NSEP), Chemistry (NSEC), and Biology (NSEB)<sup>18</sup>.

Class 12 represents the apex of high-stakes testing in India, fundamentally dictating the subsequent tertiary education trajectories. For science students, the ecosystem is dominated by the Joint Entrance Examination (JEE) Main, conducted by the NTA for admission into National Institutes of Technology (NITs) and other centrally funded institutions<sup>20</sup>. The JEE Main operates with no upper age limit but strictly caps participation to three consecutive years starting from the year of passing Class 12<sup>21</sup>. Success in JEE Main acts as a filtering mechanism for the JEE Advanced, which is administered by the Indian Institutes of Technology (IITs)<sup>23</sup>. The JEE Advanced imposes significantly harsher restrictions, limiting candidates to a maximum of two attempts in two consecutive years and enforcing a stringent age limit and minimum academic performance threshold of 75 percent aggregate marks in Class 12<sup>24</sup>. Concurrently, candidates pursuing medical careers sit for the National Eligibility cum Entrance Test (NEET UG), while those aiming for military leadership undertake the National Defence Academy (NDA) examination conducted by the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC). The NDA exam mandates a highly specific age window of 16.5 to 19.5 years and requires candidates to remain unmarried throughout their training<sup>26</sup>.

For Class 12 students in the Commerce and Arts streams, the testing environment has rapidly evolved. The Common University Entrance Test (CUET UG) has emerged as the primary vehicle for admission into Central Universities, effectively replacing decentralized, merit-based admission paradigms<sup>28</sup>. Students seeking immediate entry into elite management tracks utilize the Integrated Programme in Management Aptitude Test (IPMAT), conducted by institutions such as IIM Indore and IIM Rohtak<sup>29</sup>. The IPMAT strictly enforces age limits, generally requiring

candidates to be under twenty years old as of the application year, preventing older candidates from accessing this specific integrated pathway<sup>31</sup>. Legal aspirants undertake the Common Law Admission Test (CLAT UG) for entry into National Law Universities, an examination notable for having completely abolished its upper age limit, thereby accommodating non-traditional applicants<sup>33</sup>.

The database logic must handle "Droppers"—students who take a gap year—with extreme precision. The platform's algorithm must calculate eligibility dynamically by cross-referencing the candidate's Class 12 passing year against the specific attempt caps of each examination. For instance, a candidate who passed Class 12 in 2024 is eligible to write JEE Main in 2026, as it falls within the three-consecutive-year window<sup>22</sup>. However, that same candidate is permanently disqualified from JEE Advanced in 2026, as the strict two-year consecutive attempt limit would have expired<sup>24</sup>. Conversely, examinations like CLAT and CUET impose no such attempt or age restrictions, providing a safe harbor for long-term droppers<sup>33</sup>.

## **Vocational, Lateral, and Graduate Government Pathways**

The application's current schema exhibits a significant blind spot regarding non-traditional student bases that bypass the standard 10+2 science route. Documenting these alternative exit and entry points is vital for providing comprehensive career guidance.

Upon completing a three-year Polytechnic Diploma, the single most critical route for a student is the Lateral Entry mechanism. This pathway bypasses the first year of a standard four-year Bachelor of Technology (B.Tech) program, inserting diploma holders directly into the third semester. Because education operates as a concurrent subject in India, this mechanism is governed entirely by state-level entrance examinations rather than a central statutory body. Prominent examples include the Diploma Common Entrance Test (DCET) in Karnataka<sup>35</sup>, the Engineering Common Entrance Test (ECET) in Andhra Pradesh and Telangana, and the Joint Entrance Examination Council Uttar Pradesh (JEECUP Group K)<sup>12</sup>. Failure to include these lateral entry examinations effectively strands diploma users within the application, offering them no actionable trajectory for higher education.

The Industrial Training Institute (ITI) ecosystem operates on a distinct paradigm. ITIs generally do not utilize a centralized entrance examination; admission is predominantly merit-based, relying on Class 10 board examination performance. However, the exit architecture is rigidly tested and highly valuable. The culminating assessment is the All India Trade Test (AITT) conducted by the National Council for Vocational Training (NCVT). Passing this examination awards the National Trade Certificate (NTC). The NTC is not merely an academic milestone; it is the statutory requirement to sit for major blue-collar government employment examinations, most notably the Railway Recruitment Board's Assistant Loco Pilot (RRB ALP) and RRB Technician assessments.

For students exiting a generic undergraduate degree, the government examination ladder is segmented hierarchically by the level of executive power and starting salary. The structural progression flows from subordinate roles to elite administration. The Staff Selection

Commission Combined Graduate Level (SSC CGL) examination serves as the primary gateway for mid-level management, bureaucratic, and inspector-tier roles within Central Government ministries<sup>36</sup>. The banking sector relies on the Institute of Banking Personnel Selection Probationary Officer (IBPS PO) examination, which mandates a clear credit history and strict age brackets<sup>37</sup>. The apex of the graduate ladder is the Civil Services Examination (UPSC CSE), which recruits for the Indian Administrative Service and Indian Police Service, enforcing complex attempt limits based on social category reservations.

At the postgraduate level, the focus shifts toward research and academia. The University Grants Commission National Eligibility Test (UGC NET) and the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR UGC NET) are the definitive examinations for determining eligibility for Assistant Professorships and awarding Junior Research Fellowships (JRF)<sup>36</sup>. While there is no upper age limit for Lectureship or Assistant Professor eligibility, the JRF strictly caps the maximum age at thirty years, with standard category relaxations applied<sup>39</sup>. These examinations demand deep subject-matter expertise and represent the final academic hurdle before entering the professional academic workforce.

## Verified Examination Database Schema

The following tables constitute the verified, sanitized data structures for the specific examinations requested, adhering strictly to the required schema. The data reflects the current operational reality of the Indian testing ecosystem.

### Engineering, Science, and Technology

| Attribute       | Details                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| id              | exam_jee_main                                                                                                               |
| official_name   | Joint Entrance Examination (Main)                                                                                           |
| common_name     | JEE Main                                                                                                                    |
| conducting_body | National Testing Agency (NTA) - Central                                                                                     |
| status          | active                                                                                                                      |
| entry_point     | Class 12 (Science) or Dropper                                                                                               |
| eligibility     | Candidates must have passed Class 12 or equivalent in the current or two preceding years (e.g., 2024, 2025, or appearing in |

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                             | 2026 for the 2026 exam cycle). No age limit applies for appearing in the test itself. A maximum of three consecutive attempts is permitted. For subsequent admission into NITs, IIITs, and CFTIs, candidates must secure at least 75% aggregate marks in Class 12 (65% for SC/ST/PwD) <sup>20</sup> . |
| <b>frequency</b>            | Conducted twice a year, typically in January and April. Application windows generally open in October and February <sup>20</sup> .                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>what_it_leads_to</b>     | Admission to B.E., B.Tech, B.Arch, and B.Planning programs at NITs, IIITs, and CFTIs. Acts as the sole qualifying mechanism for JEE Advanced.                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>approximate_fee</b>      | General/OBC/EWS Male: ₹1,000; Female/SC/ST/PwD: ₹800 (Base rates historically subject to minor NTA revisions; dual paper combinations double the fee).                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>official_url</b>         | jeemain.nta.nic.in <sup>41</sup>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>last_verified</b>        | 2026-08-03                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>common_misconception</b> | Candidates frequently assume that securing a high rank in JEE Main guarantees an IIT seat; it merely grants the eligibility to sit for the entirely separate JEE Advanced examination.                                                                                                                |

| Attribute            | Details                               |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------|
| <b>id</b>            | exam_jees_advanced                    |
| <b>official_name</b> | Joint Entrance Examination (Advanced) |

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>common_name</b>          | JEE Advanced                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>conducting_body</b>      | Zonal IITs on a rotational basis under the Joint Admission Board (JAB) - Central                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>status</b>               | active                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>entry_point</b>          | Dropper or Class 12 (Science) upon clearing JEE Main                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>eligibility</b>          | Restricted to the top 2,50,000 successful candidates in the B.E./B.Tech paper of JEE Main. Imposes a strict age limit (e.g., born on or after October 1, 2001, for the 2026 cycle, with 5 years relaxation for SC/ST/PwD). Permits a maximum of two attempts in two consecutive years. Requires 75% aggregate marks in Class 12 (65% for SC/ST/PwD) or standing in the top 20 percentile of the respective board <sup>23</sup> . |
| <b>frequency</b>            | Conducted once a year, typically in late May <sup>25</sup> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>what_it_leads_to</b>     | Direct admission into undergraduate Engineering, Science, and Architecture programs across all 23 Indian Institutes of Technology (IITs) <sup>23</sup> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>approximate_fee</b>      | Female/SC/ST/PwD: ₹1,600; All other Indian nationals: ₹3,200 <sup>42</sup> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>official_url</b>         | jeeadv.ac.in <sup>42</sup>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>last_verified</b>        | 2026-08-03                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>common_misconception</b> | Students attempt to take a second drop year (third attempt) for JEE Advanced, completely unaware that the system permanently locks them out after two consecutive years following their Class 12                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |

|  |             |
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|  | graduation. |
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| Attribute               | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>id</b>               | exam_gate                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>official_name</b>    | Graduate Aptitude Test in Engineering                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>common_name</b>      | GATE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>conducting_body</b>  | IISc and seven IITs on a rotational basis - Central                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>status</b>           | active                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>entry_point</b>      | 3rd year Undergraduate, 4th year Undergraduate, or Graduate                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>eligibility</b>      | Candidates actively enrolled in the third or higher years of any undergraduate degree program, or those who have completed any government-approved degree in Engineering, Technology, Architecture, Science, Commerce, or Arts. There is no upper age limit and no restriction on the number of attempts <sup>44</sup> . |
| <b>frequency</b>        | Conducted once a year, typically in February. Application window opens in August <sup>44</sup> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>what_it_leads_to</b> | Admission into M.Tech and Ph.D. programs at IITs, IISc, and NITs with Ministry of Education financial assistance, alongside direct executive recruitment into Public Sector Undertakings (PSUs).                                                                                                                         |
| <b>approximate_fee</b>  | Female/SC/ST/PwD: ₹900; All other candidates: ₹1,800 (Rates apply to single                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |

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|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                             | papers during the regular registration period) <sup>44</sup> .                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>official_url</b>         | Domain updates annually (e.g., gate2026.iitg.ac.in) <sup>44</sup>                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>last_verified</b>        | 2026-08-03                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>common_misconception</b> | Candidates mistakenly assume GATE is strictly limited to engineering graduates, ignoring systemic reforms that made Commerce, Arts, and basic Science graduates fully eligible for specific testing papers. |

## Central University and Management Pathways

| Attribute              | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>id</b>              | exam_cuet_pg                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>official_name</b>   | Common University Entrance Test (Postgraduate)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>common_name</b>     | CUET PG                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>conducting_body</b> | National Testing Agency (NTA) - Central                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>status</b>          | active                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>entry_point</b>     | Final year Undergraduate or Graduate                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>eligibility</b>     | Candidates must have completed a bachelor's degree or be appearing in their final year of graduation. The NTA imposes no upper age limit for appearing in the exam, though individual universities may enforce specific age or minimum percentage criteria for admission to distinct |

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|                             | programs <sup>34</sup> .                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>frequency</b>            | Conducted once a year, typically in March. Application window spans December to January <sup>34</sup> .                                                                                                      |
| <b>what_it_leads_to</b>     | Admission to diverse postgraduate programs (M.A., M.Sc., LL.M., M.Com) across participating Central, State, and Private universities <sup>45</sup> .                                                         |
| <b>approximate_fee</b>      | General: ₹1,400; OBC-NCL/EWS: ₹1,200; SC/ST/Third Gender: ₹1,100; PwD: ₹1,000. These fees cover up to two test papers. Additional papers require ₹700 or ₹600 per paper based on category <sup>45</sup> .    |
| <b>official_url</b>         | exams.nta.nic.in/cuet-pg <sup>34</sup>                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>last_verified</b>        | 2026-08-03                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>common_misconception</b> | Applicants routinely select random test papers without mapping them to the specific domain codes demanded by their target universities, resulting in passing scores that are entirely useless for admission. |

| Attribute              | Details                                                                |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>id</b>              | exam_cat                                                               |
| <b>official_name</b>   | Common Admission Test                                                  |
| <b>common_name</b>     | CAT                                                                    |
| <b>conducting_body</b> | Indian Institutes of Management (IIMs) on a rotational basis - Central |

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>status</b>               | active                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>entry_point</b>          | Final year Undergraduate or Graduate                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>eligibility</b>          | Candidates must possess a Bachelor's degree with at least 50% marks or equivalent CGPA (45% for SC, ST, and PwD categories). Students in the final year of a bachelor's program are fully eligible to apply. There is no upper age limit and no restriction on the number of attempts. |
| <b>frequency</b>            | Conducted once a year, typically on the last Sunday of November. Registration runs from August to September.                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>what_it_leads_to</b>     | Admission into flagship MBA and PGDM programs at all IIMs, IITs (management schools), FMS Delhi, and premier private business schools.                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>approximate_fee</b>      | General/OBC/EWS: ₹2,400; SC/ST/PwD: ₹1,200 (Subject to annual verification as fees marginally increase over time).                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>official_url</b>         | iimcat.ac.in                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>last_verified</b>        | 2026-08-03                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>common_misconception</b> | Candidates suffer from the delusion that a 99 percentile score guarantees an IIM interview call, severely underestimating how heavily older IIMs penalize poor Class 10, Class 12, and undergraduate academic records during the shortlisting phase.                                   |

| Attribute | Details |
|-----------|---------|
|-----------|---------|

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|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>id</b>               | exam_ipmat                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>official_name</b>    | Integrated Programme in Management Aptitude Test                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>common_name</b>      | IPMAT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>conducting_body</b>  | IIM Indore and IIM Rohtak (Conducted separately) - Autonomous/Central                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>status</b>           | active                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>entry_point</b>      | Class 12 (Any Stream) or Dropper (within strict age limits)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>eligibility</b>      | Candidates must have passed Class 12 in the preceding two years or be appearing in the current year. IIM Indore removed minimum board percentage requirements, whereas IIM Rohtak requires 60% (55% for reserved). Imposes a severe age limit: General candidates must be born on or after August 1 of a specific year (e.g., Aug 1, 2006, for the 2026 exam), effectively capping the age at 20 years. SC/ST/PwD receive a 5-year relaxation <sup>30</sup> . |
| <b>frequency</b>        | Conducted once a year, typically in May. Registration spans February to April <sup>30</sup> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>what_it_leads_to</b> | Admission to the 5-year Integrated Programme in Management (BBA + MBA) at participating IIMs <sup>29</sup> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>approximate_fee</b>  | General/NC-OBC/EWS: ₹4,130; SC/ST/PwD: ₹2,065 (IIM Indore specific) <sup>30</sup> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>official_url</b>     | iimidr.ac.in (Sub-portal for IPM admissions) <sup>30</sup>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>last_verified</b>        | 2026-08-03                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>common_misconception</b> | Students prepare extensively for the written exam but fail to realize that turning 20 years old even a day before the cutoff automatically triggers rejection by the registration portal, regardless of academic brilliance. |

## Research, Academia, and Academic Talent

| Attribute              | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>id</b>              | exam_csr_net                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>official_name</b>   | Joint CSIR-UGC National Eligibility Test                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>common_name</b>     | CSIR NET                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>conducting_body</b> | National Testing Agency (NTA) on behalf of CSIR - Central                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>status</b>          | active                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>entry_point</b>     | Postgraduate or Final Year Postgraduate (Sciences)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>eligibility</b>     | Requires an M.Sc., Integrated BS-MS, B.E., B.Tech, B.Pharm, or MBBS with at least 55% marks for General/EWS (50% for reserved categories). For Junior Research Fellowship (JRF), the maximum age limit is 30 years (with up to 5 years relaxation for SC/ST/OBC-NCL/PwD/Women). There is no upper age limit for Lectureship/Assistant Professor eligibility or Ph.D. admission <sup>39</sup> . |
| <b>frequency</b>       | Conducted twice a year, typically in June and December <sup>48</sup> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |

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|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>what_it_leads_to</b>     | Awards the Junior Research Fellowship (JRF) providing stipends for doctoral research, and certifies eligibility to apply for Assistant Professor positions in Science disciplines across Indian universities <sup>36</sup> .     |
| <b>approximate_fee</b>      | General: ₹1,150; General-EWS/OBC-NCL: ₹600; SC/ST/PwD/Third Gender: ₹325 <sup>36</sup> .                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>official_url</b>         | csirnet.nta.nic.in <sup>40</sup>                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>last_verified</b>        | 2026-08-03                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>common_misconception</b> | Candidates possessing only a Bachelor's degree (like B.Tech) mistakenly apply for Lectureship, unaware they are only eligible to apply for the Junior Research Fellowship (JRF) track until they complete a master's equivalent. |

| Attribute              | Details                                                            |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>id</b>              | exam_ugc_net                                                       |
| <b>official_name</b>   | University Grants Commission National Eligibility Test             |
| <b>common_name</b>     | UGC NET                                                            |
| <b>conducting_body</b> | National Testing Agency (NTA) on behalf of UGC - Central           |
| <b>status</b>          | active                                                             |
| <b>entry_point</b>     | Postgraduate or Final Year Postgraduate (Arts/Commerce/Humanities) |
| <b>eligibility</b>     | Candidates require a Master's degree with                          |

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                             | at least 55% marks (50% for SC/ST/OBC/PwD). Final year PG students, or candidates in a 4-year UG program with 75% marks are eligible. The age limit for JRF is 30 years (with standard category relaxations). There is no age limit for Assistant Professor or Ph.D. admission eligibility <sup>36</sup> . |
| <b>frequency</b>            | Conducted twice a year, typically in June and December.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>what_it_leads_to</b>     | Awards the Junior Research Fellowship (JRF) and certifies eligibility for Assistant Professor roles in non-science disciplines in universities and colleges recognized by the UGC <sup>36</sup> .                                                                                                          |
| <b>approximate_fee</b>      | General: ₹1,150; OBC-NCL/EWS: ₹600; SC/ST/PwD/Third Gender: ₹325 (Rates generally mirror CSIR NET).                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>official_url</b>         | ugcnet.nta.ac.in                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>last_verified</b>        | 2026-08-03                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>common_misconception</b> | Candidates assume passing the UGC NET automatically guarantees them a teaching job; in reality, it only grants the statutory eligibility required to legally apply for highly competitive Assistant Professor vacancies.                                                                                   |

| Attribute            | Details                                         |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| <b>id</b>            | exam_olympiad                                   |
| <b>official_name</b> | National Standard Examination in Junior Science |

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|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>common_name</b>          | NSEJS (Junior Science Olympiad)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>conducting_body</b>      | Indian Association of Physics Teachers (IAPT) & HBCSE - Statutory/Professional                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>status</b>               | active                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>entry_point</b>          | Class 8, Class 9, or Class 10                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>eligibility</b>          | Candidates must hold an Indian passport or be eligible to hold one. Must be actively studying in Class 8, 9, or 10. Imposes a rigid birth year bracket (e.g., born between Jan 1, 2012, and Dec 31, 2013, for the 2026-27 cycle). Students who have previously appeared in international stages may face restrictions <sup>13</sup> . |
| <b>frequency</b>            | Conducted once a year, typically in November. Registration generally occurs in August/September <sup>13</sup> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>what_it_leads_to</b>     | Qualification for the Indian National Junior Science Olympiad (INJSO), Orientation-Cum-Selection Camps (OCSC), and eventually selection for the International Junior Science Olympiad (IJSO) team <sup>13</sup> .                                                                                                                     |
| <b>approximate_fee</b>      | ₹300 per student per subject <sup>13</sup> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>official_url</b>         | iapt.org.in and olympiads.hbcse.tifr.res.in <sup>13</sup>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>last_verified</b>        | 2026-08-03                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>common_misconception</b> | Parents routinely confuse these legitimate, highly prestigious government-backed Olympiads with predatory, private, for-profit school-level tests (like SOF or SilverZone) that carry absolutely no                                                                                                                                   |

|  |                                  |
|--|----------------------------------|
|  | international academic standing. |
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## Government Services and Defence

| Attribute               | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
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| <b>id</b>               | exam_nda                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>official_name</b>    | National Defence Academy and Naval Academy Examination                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>common_name</b>      | NDA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>conducting_body</b>  | Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) - Central                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>status</b>           | active                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>entry_point</b>      | Class 12 (Any stream for Army; PCM required for Navy/Air Force)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>eligibility</b>      | Unmarried male and female candidates. Strict age limits calculated based on course commencement: approximately 16.5 to 19.5 years old (e.g., born between Jan 2, 2008, and Jan 1, 2011, for NDA 2 2026). No age relaxation is provided for any reserved category. Candidates must meet rigorous physical and medical standards set by the SSB <sup>26</sup> . |
| <b>frequency</b>        | Conducted twice a year (April and September). Application windows typically open in December and May <sup>26</sup> .                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>what_it_leads_to</b> | Entry into the National Defence Academy (Army, Navy, Air Force wings) or Indian Naval Academy for training, culminating in a Commissioned Officer rank <sup>27</sup> .                                                                                                                                                                                        |

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| <b>approximate_fee</b>      | General/OBC/EWS Male: ₹100; All Female, SC, ST, and specified JCO wards: Exempt <sup>26</sup> .                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>official_url</b>         | upsc.gov.in and upsonline.nic.in <sup>26</sup>                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>last_verified</b>        | 2026-08-03                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>common_misconception</b> | Candidates assume they can apply using affidavits if their age exceeds the limit slightly; however, the UPSC strictly uses the exact Date of Birth printed on the Class 10 Matriculation certificate, instantly rejecting any deviations. |

| Attribute              | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>id</b>              | exam_cds                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>official_name</b>   | Combined Defence Services Examination                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>common_name</b>     | CDS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>conducting_body</b> | Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) - Central                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>status</b>          | active                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>entry_point</b>     | Final year Undergraduate or Graduate                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>eligibility</b>     | Unmarried males and females for Officers Training Academy (OTA); unmarried males for Indian Military Academy (IMA), Naval Academy (INA), and Air Force Academy (AFA). Degrees required: IMA/OTA (Any discipline), INA (Engineering), AFA (Degree with Physics/Math in Class 12 or B.E./B.Tech). Strict age limits generally range from 19 to 24 years depending on the |

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|                             | academy. Candidates must pass comprehensive SSB physical and medical evaluations.                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>frequency</b>            | Conducted twice a year, typically in April and September.                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>what_it_leads_to</b>     | Training and subsequent Commissioned Officer rank in the Indian Army, Navy, and Air Force.                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>approximate_fee</b>      | General/OBC Male: ₹200; All Female, SC, ST candidates: Exempt.                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>official_url</b>         | upsc.gov.in                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>last_verified</b>        | 2026-08-03                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>common_misconception</b> | Candidates uniformly assume that wearing prescription spectacles disqualifies them from military service entirely; while true for the Air Force Flying branch, the Army (IMA/OTA) and Navy have specific permissive vision limits for candidates. |

| Attribute              | Details                                          |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| <b>id</b>              | exam_upsc_cse                                    |
| <b>official_name</b>   | Civil Services Examination                       |
| <b>common_name</b>     | UPSC CSE                                         |
| <b>conducting_body</b> | Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) - Central |
| <b>status</b>          | active                                           |

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|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>entry_point</b>          | Final year Undergraduate or Graduate                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>eligibility</b>          | Candidates must hold a bachelor's degree in any discipline. Age limits range from 21 to 32 years for the General category, with relaxations of 3 years for OBC and 5 years for SC/ST. Attempt limits are capped at 6 for General, 9 for OBC, and are unlimited for SC/ST up to their respective age ceilings. |
| <b>frequency</b>            | Conducted once a year. Preliminary exams typically in May/June, Main exams in September.                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>what_it_leads_to</b>     | Elite administrative and diplomatic roles, including the Indian Administrative Service (IAS), Indian Police Service (IPS), Indian Foreign Service (IFS), and other Central Civil Services Group A and B.                                                                                                      |
| <b>approximate_fee</b>      | General/OBC Male: ₹100; All Female, SC, ST, and PwD candidates: Exempt.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>official_url</b>         | upsc.gov.in                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>last_verified</b>        | 2026-08-03                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>common_misconception</b> | Aspirants mistakenly believe that graduating from an elite institution (like an IIT) provides a statistical advantage in clearing the Preliminary exam, which relies almost entirely on dedicated static knowledge and current affairs preparation.                                                           |

| Attribute | Details      |
|-----------|--------------|
| <b>id</b> | exam_ssc_cgl |

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| <b>official_name</b>        | Staff Selection Commission Combined Graduate Level                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>common_name</b>          | SSC CGL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>conducting_body</b>      | Staff Selection Commission (SSC) - Central                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>status</b>               | active                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>entry_point</b>          | Final year Undergraduate or Graduate                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>eligibility</b>          | Requires a Bachelor's degree from a recognized university. Age limits vary heavily depending on the specific post applied for, generally ranging from 18 to 32 years. Category relaxations apply (3 years for OBC, 5 years for SC/ST). There is no limit on the number of attempts as long as the candidate remains within the age window. |
| <b>frequency</b>            | Conducted once a year.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>what_it_leads_to</b>     | Recruitment for Group B and Group C posts in various Ministries, Departments, and Organizations of the Government of India (e.g., Inspector of Income Tax, Assistant Section Officer, Sub-Inspector in CBI).                                                                                                                               |
| <b>approximate_fee</b>      | General/OBC Male: ₹100; Women, SC, ST, PwD, and Ex-Servicemen: Exempt.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>official_url</b>         | <a href="https://ssc.gov.in">ssc.gov.in</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>last_verified</b>        | 2026-08-03                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>common_misconception</b> | Aspirants overwhelmingly focus on maximizing scores in the theoretical tiers without realizing that the true bottleneck is                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |

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|  | the qualifying typing test and computer knowledge module, which routinely fail thousands of high-scoring candidates. |
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| Attribute               | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>id</b>               | exam_ibps_po                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>official_name</b>    | IBPS Probationary Officer / Management Trainee Examination                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>common_name</b>      | IBPS PO                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>conducting_body</b>  | Institute of Banking Personnel Selection (IBPS) - Autonomous/Central                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>status</b>           | active                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>entry_point</b>      | Graduate                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>eligibility</b>      | Candidates must hold a Degree (Graduation) in any discipline from a recognized university. The age limit is 20 to 30 years for the General category, with standard relaxations of 3 years for OBC and 5 years for SC/ST. Candidates are increasingly required to possess a clean credit history, typically defined as a CIBIL score above 650 <sup>37</sup> . |
| <b>frequency</b>        | Conducted once a year, with Preliminary exams generally scheduled in October.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>what_it_leads_to</b> | Direct recruitment as a Probationary Officer (PO) or Management Trainee in 11 participating Public Sector Banks across India.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |

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|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>approximate_fee</b>      | General/OBC/EWS: ₹850; SC/ST/PwD: ₹175.                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>official_url</b>         | ibps.in                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>last_verified</b>        | 2026-08-03                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>common_misconception</b> | Candidates are consistently unaware that a defaulted education or personal loan resulting in a poor CIBIL score will lead to the cancellation of their banking appointment, regardless of how highly they rank in the examination. |

## Technical Diplomas and Law

| Attribute              | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>id</b>              | exam_polytechnic                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>official_name</b>   | State Polytechnic Common Entrance Test (e.g., JEECUP, TS POLYCET)                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>common_name</b>     | Polytechnic CET                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>conducting_body</b> | State Technical Education Boards - State                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>status</b>          | active                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>entry_point</b>     | Class 10                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>eligibility</b>     | Candidates must have passed the Class 10 board examination with a minimum of 35% marks. Core subjects must include Mathematics and Science. Usually, there is no upper age limit, but a lower age limit of 14-15 years applies depending on the specific state regulations <sup>12</sup> . |

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| <b>frequency</b>            | Conducted once a year, typically in April or May.                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>what_it_leads_to</b>     | Admission into 3-year engineering and non-engineering diploma courses in state government and private polytechnic colleges.                                                                                 |
| <b>approximate_fee</b>      | Ranges from ₹300 to ₹500 depending on the state and candidate category.                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>official_url</b>         | State-specific portals (e.g., <a href="http://jeeocup.admissions.nic.in">jeeocup.admissions.nic.in</a> )                                                                                                    |
| <b>last_verified</b>        | 2026-08-03                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>common_misconception</b> | Students assume a polytechnic diploma is a terminal vocational degree, unaware that it serves as a highly efficient, direct bridge into the second year of a B.Tech program via Lateral Entry examinations. |

| Attribute              | Details                                                      |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>id</b>              | exam_clat_ug                                                 |
| <b>official_name</b>   | Common Law Admission Test (Undergraduate)                    |
| <b>common_name</b>     | CLAT UG                                                      |
| <b>conducting_body</b> | Consortium of National Law Universities - Autonomous/Central |
| <b>status</b>          | active                                                       |
| <b>entry_point</b>     | Class 12 or Dropper                                          |

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| <b>eligibility</b>          | Candidates must have passed Class 12 or an equivalent examination with a minimum of 45% marks (40% for SC/ST). Candidates appearing for the qualifying examination in the exam year are eligible to apply. There is absolutely no upper age limit for appearing in the CLAT UG <sup>33</sup> . |
| <b>frequency</b>            | Conducted once a year, typically in December for the following academic year.                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>what_it_leads_to</b>     | Admission into the 5-year integrated B.A. LL.B (Hons.) programs across 24 participating National Law Universities (NLUs) in India.                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>approximate_fee</b>      | General/OBC/PWD/NRI: ₹4,000; SC/ST/BPL: ₹3,500.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>official_url</b>         | consortiumofnlus.ac.in <sup>33</sup>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>last_verified</b>        | 2026-08-03                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>common_misconception</b> | Candidates mistakenly assume that because law requires extensive reading, the exam relies on rote memorization of legal statutes, whereas the modern CLAT heavily tests reading comprehension, logic, and deductive reasoning from unseen passages.                                            |

## Invalidated, Discontinued, and Fabricated Entries

To maintain database integrity, it is equally important to explicitly map what no longer exists. The following entries currently present in legacy datasets or promoted by predatory coaching institutions must be scrubbed, disabled, or flagged with the corrective status to prevent user misdirection.

| App Database Entry | The Fallacy / Common Belief | The Factual Correction for the Database |
|--------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
|--------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------|

|                             |                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>exam_ntse</b>            | NTSE is an active, prestigious exam for Class 9 and Class 10 students looking for government scholarships. | <b>Status: Stalled.</b> The scheme expired on March 31, 2021, and the NCERT officially stalled the exam in October 2022 due to lack of Ministry approval <sup>2</sup> . Furthermore, it was never a Class 9 exam domestically; Class 9 eligibility was solely for Indian students studying abroad <sup>7</sup> . |
| <b>exam_yasasvi_yet</b>     | The PM YASASVI scheme requires students to pass the NTA-conducted YET entrance examination.                | <b>Status: Discontinued.</b> The NTA entrance test (YET) was permanently scrapped. The scholarship remains active but selection is now purely merit-based on Class 8 marks (for Class 9 entry) or Class 10 marks (for Class 11 entry) <sup>8</sup> .                                                             |
| <b>exam_kvpy</b>            | KVPY is the premier exam for Class 11 and 12 science students to secure research fellowships.              | <b>Status: Discontinued.</b> The Department of Science and Technology scrapped the KVPY in 2022. It has been entirely replaced by and subsumed into the INSPIRE fellowship scheme <sup>17</sup> .                                                                                                                |
| <b>exam_jees_foundation</b> | An official lower-level pre-engineering exam conducted to prepare middle school students.                  | <b>Status: Fabricated.</b> This is not a real examination. It is a coaching industry marketing term designed to sell prolonged tuition packages to parents of Class 6-10 students <sup>10</sup> .                                                                                                                |
| <b>exam_neet_foundation</b> | An official lower-level pre-medical exam conducted by the NTA or CBSE.                                     | <b>Status: Fabricated.</b> Identical to JEE Foundation, this possesses no official statutory recognition and                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

|                                |                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                |                                                                                         | exists purely as a private industry product <sup>10</sup> .                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>exam_rimc_class6</b>        | RIMC admits students into Class 6, similar to the entry points of Sainik Schools.       | <b>Status: Invalid Rule.</b> RIMC enforces a rigid mandate admitting students <i>only</i> into Class 8, demanding candidates be strictly between 11.5 and 13 years old <sup>9</sup> .                              |
| <b>exam_iti_apprenticeship</b> | The ITI Apprenticeship acts as the preliminary entrance examination to get into an ITI. | <b>Status: Misclassification.</b> It is not an entrance exam. It is a post-certification, on-the-job industrial placement scheme governed by the Apprentices Act, 1961, occurring <i>after</i> one obtains an NTC. |

By implementing this verified architectural schema, the application will transition from a fragmented directory into a highly rigorous career guidance engine. The absolute fidelity of entry points, dynamic eligibility matrices, and accurate examination statuses ensures that students will not misallocate crucial preparation years toward obsolete testing targets.

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